Unit 7 — Mediation: A German Feature Article

Track E · Klasse 10 · Niveau E

Learning objectives I

- *I can mediate a 250-word German feature article into 8 English sentences.*
- *I can preserve voice and register; mark hedged claims; drop ceremony.*
- *I can use 8 reporting verbs.*

Lead-in I

Maja's German aunt forwarded a feature article from a national paper about a small-town mayor who had rebuilt the local library on a near-zero budget. Maja's English-speaking pen-pal in Toronto, who is studying public administration, asked for a real summary, not a textbook one.

Vocabulary I

- to admit
- to claim
- to argue
- to add
- to confirm
- to deny
- to point out
- to stress
- to note
- to concede
- to dismiss
- to maintain

Reading I

Source — *German feature article (excerpt)*
Bürgermeisterin Anna Vogel hat ihre kleine Gemeinde, deren Bibliothek seit Jahren geschlossen war, mit einem unkonventionellen Plan zurück auf die Karte gebracht. Statt auf große Zuschüsse zu warten, organisierte sie eine Reihe von Sonntags-Workshops, in denen Bewohner gespendete Bücher sortierten und Regale bauten. ”Ich habe nicht erwartet, dass es funktioniert,” gab Vogel zu, ”aber die Leute kamen zuverlässig.” Die neue Bibliothek wurde nach acht Monaten eröffnet. Kritiker werfen ihr vor, das Modell sei nicht skalierbar.

Mediation — feature-article moves
Voice — keep the speaker’s voice via reported speech with the right verb (*admitted, claimed,*

Reading II

added, argued). *Register* — match the addressee. A peer-message drops the *Bürgermeisterin* honorifics; a public-admin reader keeps role + name. *Hedge* — preserve the journalist's hedging (*Critics argue …*) without inventing certainty.

Reporting verbs (extended)
to admit, to claim, to argue, to add, to confirm, to deny, to point out, to stress, to note, to concede, to dismiss, to maintain.

Practise I

Niveau E — controlled

1. Match German verb → English: zugeben → ?, behaupten → ?, hinzufügen → ?, abstreiten → ?
2. Choose the most accurate verb for: *Vogel said: 'I didn't expect it to work, but people came.'*

Niveau E — productive

3. Build a 6-sentence English mediation of the source above.

Your turn I

Mediation, 8 sentences. Read the German source above. Write 8 English sentences for an English-speaking public-administration student. Preserve voice + use 5 reporting verbs.

Sample

Hi Jordan, here's the gist of that feature on small-town public administration. Mayor Anna Vogel rebuilt her town's library — closed for years — with a near-zero budget. Rather than waiting for grants, she organised a series of Sunday workshops in which residents sorted donated books and built shelves themselves. Vogel admitted that she hadn't expected the plan to work; she added, with some surprise, that people had shown up reliably. The library opened eight months later. Critics argue, however, that the model is not scalable beyond small towns. The article stresses that

Your turn II

Vogel doesn't claim it is — only that it worked here. The reporting tone is admiring but cautious.

Reflect I

- I can mediate a feature article into 8 English sentences.
- I can preserve voice and register.
- I can use 5 reporting verbs accurately.

Further reading / listening I

- Goethe-Institut — Sprachmittlungs-Beispielaufgaben Oberstufe.
- The Atlantic — *CityLab* features for register comparison.